

Access

The Gorge is accessed through the road that goes 20km north of Palapye from the Gaborone-Francistown A1 road before taking an easterly turn and following the tarred Kgagodi road. About 14km from the turn, the road turns south on a dirt track for 33km and there lies the Moremi village on the valley. The gorge is a further 4km south of the village. All types of vehicles can access the village, but to visit the gorge, a four-wheel drive vehicle is required.

Some Rules

Moremi Manonnye gorge is a national monument administered by the Botswana National Museum and protected by the revised Monuments and Relics Act (2001). Adherence to some basic guidelines will make your visit worthwhile and ensure the continued protection of a part of Botswana's unique heritage.

- Respect and obey the taboos and beliefs associated with the gorge.
- Entry fees are paid to the Moremi-Manonnye Conservation Trust office before proceeding to the gorge.
- Camp in designated campsites only.
- Park in designated car parks.
- Use official routes only
- Do not litter
- Do not remove any artifacts from and around the gorge.
- Do not go near breeding areas of the vultures.
- Do not collect any rock samples, crabs, plants of fetch spring water.
- Swimming in the pools is prohibited.

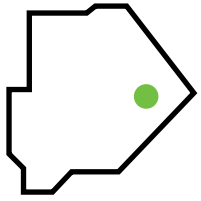
PLEASE NOTE:

Researchers and commercial photographers, contact the Botswana National Museum for permission.



MOREMI-MANONNYE

gorge



Designation:
Natural & Cultural
Area: approx. 3km²
Adoption priorities:
visitor interpretation centre, field assistants, signage, trails

For further information, contact:
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BOTSWANA national museum

ADOPT A MONUMENT
GIVING LIFE TO BOTSWANA'S HERITAGE SITES

MR201511

Natural Heritage Site | **Cultural Heritage Site**

MOREMI-MANONNYE GORGE

Moremi-Manonnye Gorge is one of the most spectacular gorges found in the country. It consists of a number of pools with waterfalls of outstanding natural scenic beauty. The gorge is part of the geological features that developed as a result of the weathering of resistant quartzites of the Precambrian rocks, about 1700 million years ago, found around the Tswapong hills. The name Moremi-Manonnye is derived from its being a breeding place for vultures. Moremi gorge is located in Moremi village, which lies 67 kilometers east of Palapye.

Cultural and Natural Heritage

Found in the area are historical remains such as the grave of Kgosi Mapulane and his immediate successive sons as well as the original village and school. Another historical feature is the legendary "Tshekedi's road" which was meant to connect Moeng College to Palapye. Its construction was denounced by *badimo* or the ancestral spirits, and hence abandoned.

Various animals, including large mammals, birds, reptiles and amphibians are found around the gorge. However, both the numbers and the diversity of larger mammals have presumably declined. Most importantly, the Manonnye gorge is a breeding place for the Cape vulture, Gyps coporotheres and Black eagle, *Aquila verreauxii* which are classified as vulnerable and endangered. Therefore thus greater care needs to be taken to ensure the protection of these birds.





The Community and the Gorge

According to oral history, the community of Moremi are the first Bapedi or Batswapong to settle in the area around the 1830's under the leadership of Kgosi Mapulane. They first settled a kilometre from the mouth of Manonnye spring, which served as a source of water for them and their livestock. The Moremi community now use it mainly for tourism activities without compromising its authenticity as a sacred place. They formed the Moremi-Manonnye Conservation Trust, which runs the tourism activities on their behalf.

Cultural Beliefs and Values

The Bapedi/Batswapong believe that the Moremi-Manonnye gorge is a resting home for their *badimo*, or ancestral spirits. There is a sacred cave within the gorge with rock paintings and its exact location is a closely guarded secret of the *Komana*. The *Komana* is a group of people who carry out mediation duties between the badimo and the community. The *Badimo* remain a powerful force in the daily social and spiritual life of the village.





The gorge has several taboos, beliefs and practices including the following:

- The badimos' secrets must not be divulged to unauthorized people.
- During ceremonies for the ancestors and funerals, silence must be observed.
- During the ritual ceremony, Komana people must abstain from sexual activity. This ceremony is usually performed at night. Visitors are warned if there is such an occasion is to take place during their visit.
- Drinking alcohol, making noise, swimming in the gorge and other disturbances are all prohibited.